

Meeting Summary — September 9, 2026

Participants: Isak Gutierrez, Thomas Abshier, Joelle Ater **Duration:** ~2 hours (7:28 AM – ~8:50 AM)

Key Decisions

1. Start Selling Now — Don't Wait for Medicare/DME

The group agreed to stop blocking on the Medicare/DME question and focus on what they can do immediately: - Get **product liability insurance** (Isak — no dependencies) - Set up **financing company** for buyer payment plans (Joelle) - Finalize **bank account** (Isak — operating agreement submitted) - Set up **Stripe/payment processing** (Joelle — needs bank info) - Get **photos and video** of the walker (Isak + Charlie) - Build **pitch deck / one-pager** (Joelle — needs media first) - Set up **CRM** (Joelle)

2. DME: Apply Now, Don't Buy

Thomas decided: **apply for our own DME enrollment now** rather than buying one (\$1M+ for a mature one). The year-long wait doubles as market research time. If it turns out to be useless, they can hold it 36 months and sell it for \$1M+. “There will be no loss in it.”

3. Pricing Settled at \$12,000 MSRP (Working Number)

Thomas acknowledged \$16,000 is “optimistic” and not competitive. \$12,000 is where other players are. Working economics at \$12K: - Medicare pays 75% = \$9,000 - DME takes 30% = \$2,700 - Ideomotion gets = \$6,300 - Minus COGS (\$3,500) = **\$2,800 profit per unit**

If selling through someone else's DME (not owning one): Ideomotion wholesale at \$6,000, making ~\$2,500 per unit after COGS.

4. Buyback Program (Joelle's Idea)

Sell direct now with financing. When Medicare/DME is ready, offer to **buy back the used unit at \$6,000 (wholesale)**, give the customer a new prescribed unit through Medicare, then refurbish and resell the returned unit for \$9,000. Thomas: “That is thinking outside the box.”

5. Steve Blank / Startup Owner's Manual Approach

Thomas has been reading the book Joelle recommended. Key takeaway: find out what sells before scaling. Use the next year (while DME application processes) to do market research by actually selling — not just surveying.

6. Three Sales Channels to Test Simultaneously

Each person takes a different market: - **Joelle:** Disability housing / adult foster care homes (Riley's Residence connections in Idaho), plus her uncle's caregiving org in Spokane (also has pharma

sales experience with doctors) - **Charlie:** Direct to individuals (his proven superpower — in-person demos) - **Isak:** Doctors, PTs, OTs, institutions, SciFit follow-up

7. Leonard Update

Thomas spoke to Leonard on Sunday. Leonard has emailed his overseas sourcing contact (Nigeria/Hong Kong guy) about manufacturing the Traveler. Traveler CAD drawings exist and are the most documented. LiftWalker (“Flyer”) package expected soon. All CAD files need to get on GitHub.

Action Items

#	Item	Owner	Priority
1	Get product liability insurance quotes	Isak	Immediate
2	Research and set up financing company	Joelle	Immediate
3	Finalize bank account (submit operating agreement to Valley Strong)	Isak	Immediate
4	Set up Stripe / payment processing	Joelle	After bank
5	Photo/video shoot with Charlie and assembled walker	Isak	This week
6	Create pitch deck / one-pager for doctors and facilities	Joelle	After media
7	Set up CRM	Joelle	This week
8	Work on logo concepts	Joelle	Ongoing
9	Follow up with Leonard re: overseas manufacturing quotes and CAD files	Isak	This week
10	Get all CAD files onto GitHub (IDEOMOTION-CAD repo)	Isak + Leonard	This week

#	Item	Owner	Priority
11	Follow up with SciFit Petaluma	Isak	This week
12	Call Medi-Cal re: what they actually pay for walkers/lifts	Isak	This week
13	Check on Mom's soft goods production — help set up sewing workspace	Isak	This week
14	Start DME enrollment application process	Isak	Begin research
15	Research which doctors prescribe wheelchair renewals (Medicare annual Rx)	Joelle	Ask friend at Riley's Residence
16	Contact uncle in Spokane re: caregiving org + pharma sales experience	Joelle	This week

Notable Ideas

DME as investment: If it doesn't work for selling walkers, hold it 36 months and sell the enrollment for \$1M+. Zero downside.

Ambassadors: Direct-sale customers become ambassadors to their own doctors. They have a warm market — “I got this thing, it's fantastic, you should know about it so you can tell other people.”

Medicare annual wheelchair re-prescription: Joelle's friend has to take her wheelchair-bound son to a doctor every year to get the wheelchair re-prescribed for Medicare. This means there's a **specific type of doctor who sees wheelchair patients annually** — that's a targetable prescriber population.

Anti-kickback note: Thomas shared story about Margo receiving a \$4,000 drug kickback check despite never prescribing drugs. Confirms kickbacks happen but are illegal (Anti-Kickback Statute). Don't go there.

Key Quotes

Trading notes moved to trading log — Isak sold at worst moment again (“the superpower of humanity”); both still doing 1-contract penny poker from 9/1 decision.

Thomas: “We’re taxiing. We’re not lifting off. But we’re picking up airspeed. We’ll eventually be able to pull back the stick.”

Joelle: “What if we had a buyback program so they could eventually get it prescribed? So it’d be like a no-loss to get it right now.”

Thomas: “Oh my gosh, that is a totally new concept.”

Joelle: “This is why it stayed a small mom-and-pop business for almost four decades.”

Thomas: “The person that has to be doing this is the founder. But that’s the problem — we need to find out how real people can sell.”

Joelle: “What if we develop superpowers?”